

SpaceX S-1 Analysis

Second-Order Winners — Who Rides the Uptrend Without Buying SPCX

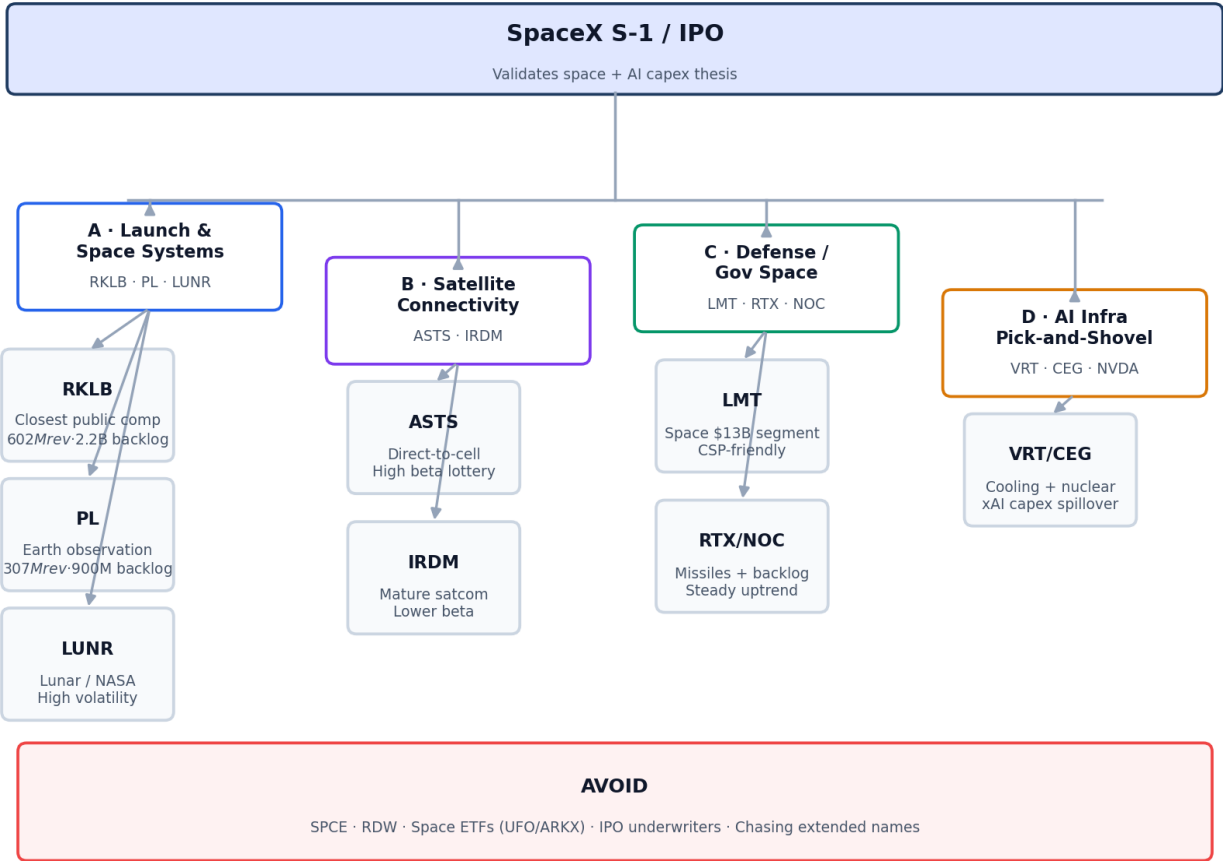
Report Date: May 20, 2026 | **Subject:** Space Exploration Technologies Corp. (CIK 0001181412) | **Ticker:** SPCX (expected)

SpaceX filed the largest IPO registration statement in history on May 20, 2026 — targeting a \$1.75–2.0T valuation and up to \$75B in proceeds. This report maps the investment landscape for investors who prefer to avoid SPCX volatility and instead ride validated second-order winners.

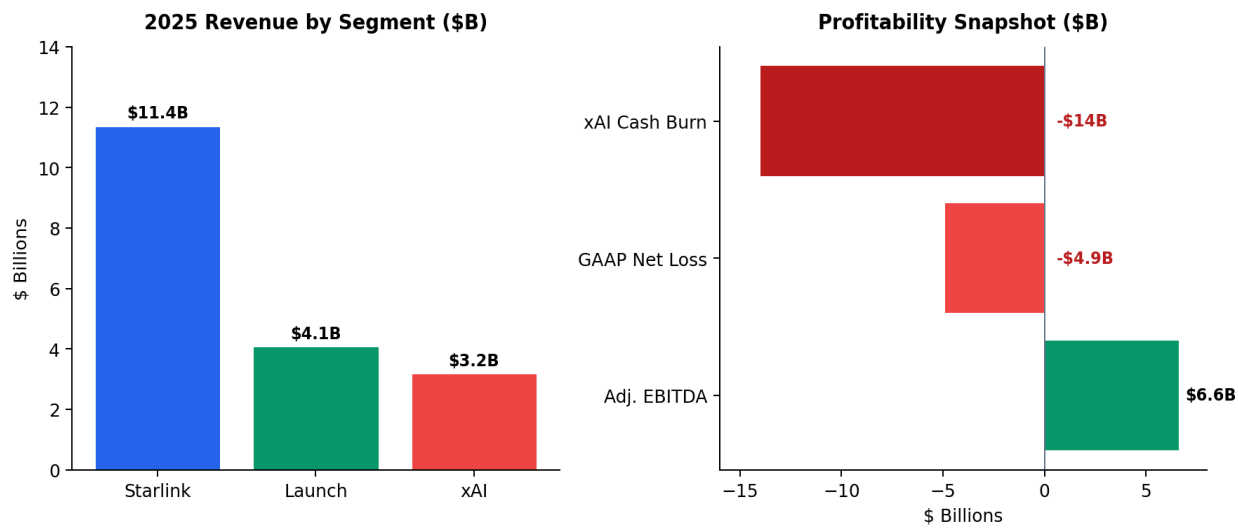
Metric	Value
Target Valuation	\$1.75 – 2.0+ Trillion
Capital Raise	Up to \$75 Billion
2025 Revenue	\$18.7B (+43% YoY)
2025 GAAP Net Loss	-\$4.9 Billion
2025 Adj. EBITDA	\$6.6 Billion
Revenue Multiple (at IPO)	~95x Trailing Revenue
Prior IPO Record (Aramco 2019)	\$29.4 Billion

The Winning Map — Bucketed Tree

The SpaceX IPO validates two mega-theses: (1) space and satellite connectivity as profitable infrastructure, and (2) massive AI capex that reprices the entire compute stack. Quality names with backlog and execution get dragged up; hype names get exposed.



SpaceX Financial Snapshot



Segment Breakdown

Segment	Revenue	Growth	Profitability
Starlink	\$11.4B (61%)	+48% YoY	\$4.4B operating profit
Launch Services	\$4.1B (22%)	+8% YoY	Profitable (gov contracts)
xAI	\$3.2B (17%)	+22% YoY	~\$14B cash burn

Key insight: Starlink is the financial engine. xAI is the highest-risk, highest-optionality bet — absorbing 60% of capex (~\$20B) while generating only 17% of revenue. The entire \$4.9B net loss is attributable to xAI.

Tier 1 — Highest-Conviction Winners

Rocket Lab (RKLB) — The Public SpaceX Proxy

Closest pure-play to SpaceX's launch + spacecraft stack. 2025 revenue ~\$602M (+38%), backlog ~\$1.85–2.2B (+73%). Neutron heavy-lift targeting Q4 2026. Already +57% since IPO rumors — wait for pullback to 21-EMA, not a chase.

Planet Labs (PL) — The Boring Winner

Earth observation with proven recurring revenue. FY2026 revenue ~\$307M (+26%), backlog ~\$900M (+79%). Less direct Starlink competition than ASTS. Government + commercial imagery demand is structural.

Lockheed Martin (LMT) / RTX / Northrop (NOC) — Defense Space

LMT space segment: \$13B revenue (+4%), guided \$13.5–13.8B for 2026. NOC: \$95B+ backlog. Lower volatility, dividend, options liquidity. Best for CSP / covered-call playbook.

Tier 2 — Satellite Connectivity (Higher Beta)

AST SpaceMobile (ASTS): Direct-to-cell from space with AT&T/Verizon partnerships. Speculative winner — high beta lottery ticket only on deep pullbacks.

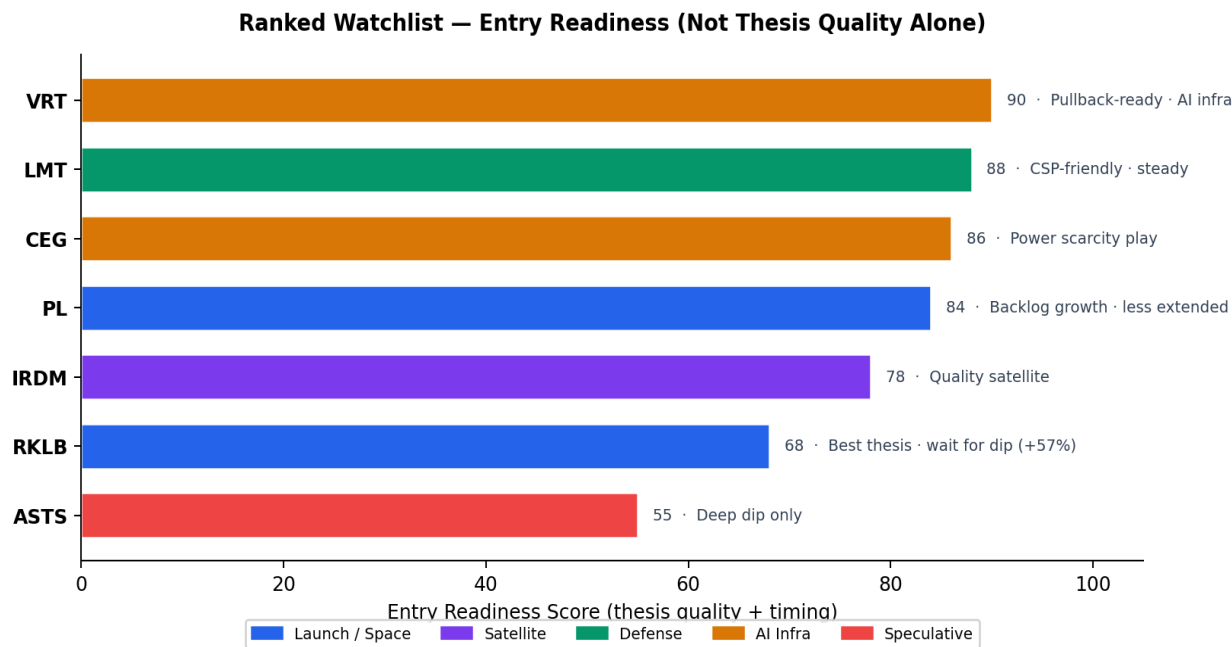
Iridium (IRDM): Mature satcom with recurring revenue. Often rises when speculative space names fall — quality flight within the sector.

Tier 3 — AI Infrastructure Pick-and-Shovel

Ticker	Role	Thesis
VRT	Data center cooling	Every GW of AI compute needs thermal management
CEG	Nuclear baseload	AI power scarcity → premium for 24/7 carbon-free power
NEE	Utility + renewables	Grid interconnection bottleneck; Meta 2.5 GW deal
NVDA / AVGO	AI chips	xAI burn = more GPU demand
EQIX / DLR	Data center REITs	Land + power + connectivity; less binary than space

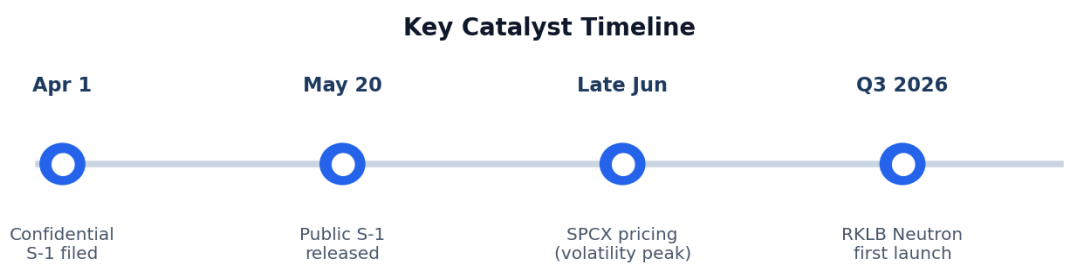
Ranked Watchlist — Entry Readiness

How to read this chart: Scores reflect *entry readiness* — thesis quality combined with current timing. RKLB is the strongest SpaceX proxy by thesis, but ranks lower here because it has already run +57% and is not a buy-today setup. VRT and LMT rank higher because they offer the same sector tailwind with better pullback entry conditions.



RKLB ranks #1 on thesis quality (best public SpaceX comp) but lower here because it is extended +57%. Higher score = better setup to enter now.

Key Catalyst Timeline



Practical Playbook Matrix

Strategy	Tickers	Recommended Action	Risk
Conservative uptrend	LMT, RTX, VRT, CEG	Wait for the stock to dip toward its 8- or 21-day moving average (a short-term trend line that tracks recent price). Then sell cash-secured puts: you collect premium upfront and only buy shares if the price falls to your chosen strike.	Low

Growth on pullback	PL, RKL B (on dip)	Do not buy at today's price. Wait for a post-IPO sector selloff or a dip toward the 21-day moving average, then buy shares. RKL B has a strong thesis but is already up 57% — patience is required.	Medium
High beta lottery	ASTS	Only consider after a sharp price drop (10%+). If you buy shares, sell covered calls against them — this means selling call options on stock you already own to earn monthly premium while holding a volatile position.	High
Timing gate	Extended names	Some names belong on your watchlist but not in your portfolio today. RKL B has run +57% on IPO excitement — monitor it and wait for a meaningful pullback before entering.	—

What to Avoid

- Virgin Galactic (SPCE) — no meaningful revenue
- Redwire (RDW) — turnaround with execution risk
- Intuitive Machines (LUNR) — NASA lottery, very volatile
- Space ETFs (UFO, ARKX) — dilute winners with weak holdings; already +30% YTD
- IPO underwriters (MS, GS) — one-time fee pop, not sustained uptrend
- Chasing extended names — RKL B +57% (watchlist, not buy today), ASTS on Starlink hype

Bottom Line

SPCX validates the sector — it does not lift all boats equally. Winners have revenue, backlog, and execution. The edge is not buying the IPO; it is riding the re-rating in quality names on pullbacks while avoiding the post-IPO volatility window. RKL B is the best thesis proxy but requires a dip entry; VRT and CEG offer cleaner near-term setups with the same AI capex tailwind.

Disclaimer: This report is for informational purposes only and does not constitute investment advice, a recommendation, or a solicitation to buy or sell any security. All figures reflect publicly reported estimates and SEC filing data as of May 2026. Past performance does not guarantee future results. Conduct your own due diligence before making investment decisions.